American-prepared agreement to restore the LOC. Over one thousand Indian and Pakistani forces died in the fighting.[48]

What impact did India and Pakistan's nuclear weapons capabilities have on the outbreak and resolution of the Kargil conflict?

ŠUMIT GANGULY

The origins of the Kargil conflict can be traced to Pakistan's interest in jump-starting the Kashmir insurgency. By the late 1990s, through a combination of political concessions and its counterinsurgency strategy, the Indian state had managed to restore a modicum of order if not law in Kashmir.[49] Furthermore, as a consequence of the restoration of some semblance of normalcy in the state, global attention on the Kashmir question was starting to wane. Under the circumstances, it was important for the Pakistani military to try and refocus international concern on the Kashmir question. To this end, the Pakistani military chose to make incursions in a region of Kashmir where none of India's vital security interests would be implicated.[50] If these incursions across the line of control proved successful, the Pakistani military would have been able to interdict one of the principal supply lines, National Highway 1A, to Indian troops on the disputed Siachen Glacier.[51] Such a military success would have significantly complicated India's logistical efforts to supply its troops on the glacier but would not have constituted a vital threat to its security interests.

Nevertheless, India mounted a concerted military operation to dislodge the Pakistani intruders. Though the Indian response was vigorous, it is important to note that the military were confronted with significant constraints on their actions. First, despite the availability of three strike corps, composed of sixty thousand soldiers broken down into three divisions each in the Punjab and Rajasthan, no orders were issued to open a second front.[52] Second, the Indian Air Force was used in offensive operations to dislodge carefully entrenched Pakistani forces along mountain redoubts. However, IAF personnel were issued strict orders not to cross the line of control under any circumstances. Even though this greatly hamstrung air